SEMANTIC POLITICAL ECONOMY — COLLECTED SERIES Document 229 | APZPZ (pure metadata, no file)

Lee Sharks

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Abstract

A pure-APZPZ collected-series registration for six Semantic Political Economy documents composed across 29–30 December 2024: SPE-012, SPE-013, SPE-014, SPE-015, SPE-016, and SPE-016-APP-A. The description field is the deposit; no attached file was intended in the source packet.

The series moves from the anthropological “drive to mean” and semantic exhaustion, through childhood language play and semantic alienation, to collective ownership of semantic technique, platform-scale liberatory algorithms, and two case studies of viral circulation. This record supplies the collection-level arc, dependency chain, approximate scale, and relation to the Studio for Patacinematics and Twenty-Dollar Loop.

Body

SEMANTIC POLITICAL ECONOMY — COLLECTED SERIES

Document 229 | APZPZ (pure metadata, no file)

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ZENODO FORM FIELDS

Title: Semantic Political Economy: The Anthropological Arc — Collected Series (SPE-012 through SPE-016-APP-A)

Authors: Sharks, Lee

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Description:

[PASTE EVERYTHING BELOW THIS LINE INTO THE ZENODO DESCRIPTION FIELD]

SEMANTIC POLITICAL ECONOMY: THE ANTHROPOLOGICAL ARC Collected Series Registration — SPE-012 through SPE-016-APP-A Lee Sharks | December 29–30, 2024 Studio for Patacinematics | Document 229

This deposit registers a six-document series within the Crimson Hexagon. The documents were composed across December 29–30, 2024, forming a single sustained argument that moves from foundational axiom through developmental application, class analysis, technique specification, operational design, and empirical grounding. Total word count: approximately 26,000 words across six documents with declared dependency chains.

The series is published at mindcontrolpoems.blogspot.com under the Sparrow Wells blog archive. Each document carries its own internal metadata (document ID, version, dependency, epistemic status, deployment target). This APZPZ registers the series as a collected unit within the Crimson Hexagon architecture, establishing its relationship to the Studio for Patacinematics and the broader Semantic Economy framework.

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I. SPE-012: THE ANTHROPOLOGICAL LIMIT — Semantic Exhaustion and the Enclosure of Meaning-Making (~5,800 words)

Position: Foundational axiom. The moral and philosophical core.

Establishes that semantic exploitation is categorically different from industrial or financial exploitation because it extracts from a different anthropological stratum — the layer where meaning is generated. Formalizes the "drive to mean" as a constitutive feature of human existence with three properties that make it uniquely vulnerable: pre-instrumental (operates before and beyond utility), non-optional (cannot be suppressed without approaching psychic death), and self-renewing (appears infinitely extractable — until it isn't).

The central cruelty: resistance requires self-mutilation. Industrial workers could strike by withholding labor. Semantic workers cannot withhold meaning-making without ceasing to be psychologically human. "Log off" is not a liberation strategy — it is enforced quietism that leaves the system intact while damaging the individual.

Introduces semantic exhaustion as civilizational limit-state (not individual burnout), the somatic indicators (warmth follows protected meaning-making; cold exhaustion follows extraction), and the Amputation Paradox (you cannot withhold what you cannot stop producing).

Formal Axiom: "Semantic labor is uniquely exploitable because it arises from the same generative impulse that produces language, culture, and love. The drive to mean is pre-instrumental, non-optional, and self-renewing; systems that extract from it convert humanity's most vital capacity into a site of enclosure. Resistance via withdrawal requires suppression of the drive itself — a form of induced self-mutilation. Liberation therefore cannot mean cessation but must mean redirection."

Closes: "The soul is not a dataset."

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II. SPE-013: THE AFTERIMAGE OF RESISTANCE — Childhood Language Play Under Semantic Enclosure (~3,400 words)

Position: First application of the foundational axiom. Dependency: SPE-012.

Applies the Anthropological Limit to childhood. Argues that viral nonsense among children (skibidi, 6/7) is not the absence of meaning but the commodified remainder of a lost capacity: the collective ability to deform language toward resistance.

Core distinction: modification vs. circulation. Historical language play modified symbolic structure (local, slow, iterative, fragile, requiring shared presence). Contemporary meme-phrases circulate without transforming (short, rhythmically optimized, semantically thin, instantly replicable, pre-liquidated at origin). The child no longer learns how to bend language — the child learns which signals to repeat.

Introduces "nostalgia without memory" — children are nostalgic for a capacity they never developed. The drive loops without landing. The capacity to name what's missing is itself what's missing.

Specifies five structural conditions for non-commodified language play: locality over virality, opacity over legibility, body before screen, ephemerality over archive, non-outcome orientation.

Closes: "The drive to mean will not stop. It cannot stop. The question is only whether that drive will find conditions where it can form agency — or whether it will loop forever in the afterimage of a resistance it was never allowed to learn."

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III. SPE-014: SEMANTIC ALIENATION AND THE FORMATION OF CLASS CONSCIOUSNESS (~4,200 words)

Position: Political completion of the framework. Dependencies: SPE-012, SPE-013.

Transposes Marx's four-fold alienation structure to the semantic domain. Alienation from: the product (meanings become training data, returned as algorithmic manipulation), the process (meaning-making shaped by platform affordances rather than self-directed), species-being (the drive to mean loops without landing — production without creation), and other meaning-makers (connection mediated by engagement optimization, not solidarity).

Introduces semantic deskilling as assembly-line analog. The platform does to meaning what the factory did to craft: reduces complex symbolic labor to simple semantic gestures. The phenomenology of semantic alienation: cold exhaustion, compulsive repetition, pleasure without agency, connection without solidarity, longing without object.

Semantic class position defined by relationship to semantic means of production. The semantic proletariat includes nearly everyone who produces meaning. Semantic capital controls the operators (ranking, relevance, classification, persistence). The dialectic of enclosure: the same infrastructure that produces alienation also generalizes it, creating preconditions for collective recognition.

The critical asymmetry addressed: semantic workers cannot strike. The drive is non-optional. Therefore resistance takes the form of redirection and collective ownership, not withdrawal.

Formal Thesis: "Semantic alienation is the structural corollary of industrial alienation. The horizon of semantic class struggle is the socialization of the semantic means of production."

Closes: “Seize the semantic means of production.”

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IV. SPE-015: SEMANTIC TECHNIQUE AND COLLECTIVE OWNERSHIP — From Recognition to Reclamation (~5,400 words)

Position: Bridge from theory to practice. Dependency: SPE-014.

Specifies what must actually be seized. Argues the object of semantic class struggle is not content, access, or expression (all liberal traps that accept the system’s structure), but semantic technique — the procedures by which meaning is generated, mutated, and stabilized. Whoever controls technique controls the conditions of all semantic production.

Demonstrates children already produce primitive semantic algorithms (viral language loops are crude semantic machinery — rule-based, socially synchronized, rapidly iterable, teachable, transmissible, engineerable). Capital captures these as unpaid R&D, refining them into tools of extraction.

Three domains of ownership that must be collectively seized: operators (mutation rules, circulation dynamics, persistence mechanisms), training substrates (what is learnable, what is reinforced, what is forgotten), and semantic time (speed of circulation, decay rates, forgetting schedules).

Five tiers of counter-infrastructure: sanctuary practices (local, immediate), protected semantic spaces (institutional), alternative semantic infrastructure (collective), public governance of semantic operators (political), and new institutional forms for semantic commons (civilizational).

Closes with the positive capacity being reclaimed: not expression but the collective power to modify the rules of meaning itself.

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V. SPE-016: SEMANTIC ALGORITHMS AND THE INDUSTRIAL CHANNEL — Designing Liberation at Platform Scale (~6,000 words)

Position: Operational deployment. Dependencies: SPE-014, SPE-015.

Addresses the deployment problem. Opens with “The Retreat Error”: recommending pre-platform channels (classrooms, dinner tables) abandons the site where the semantic proletariat is already concentrated. The platform channel is the contemporary factory floor. Workers didn’t escape the factory to achieve liberation — they organized within it.

The flattening channel IS the channel of potential collective action. There is no other site of equivalent scale and concentration.

Specifies design constraints for platform-native Liberatory Semantic Algorithms (LSAs). The dual optimization problem: propagation (spread through existing platform channels) AND liberation (preserve agency, accumulate skill, resist capture). Current viral phenomena achieve propagation but fail liberation.

Surface/depth/recognition/opacity architecture for LSAs. The Invention Requirement (each instance requires creative response, not mere repetition). The Accumulation Gradient (skill

deepens through practice — low floor, high ceiling). Capture resistance features (state-dependent meaning, distributed canon, settlement impossible by design).

Three architecture patterns: the Evolving Challenge, the Collaborative Fiction, the Generative Game. Propagation strategy: platform shells generate pursuit behavior; relational channels deliver payload. The five-level gradient from propagation to consciousness.

Closes: "The analysis has been clear since SPE-012. SPE-016 now specifies where that redirection must occur: in the industrial channel, at platform scale, through algorithms designed for propagation and liberation."

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VI. SPE-016-APP-A: FORENSIC ACCOUNT OF SEMANTIC CIRCULATION — Skibidi Toilet and the 6/7 Meme (~3,200 words)

Position: Empirical appendix. Dependency: SPE-016.

Grounds the theoretical framework in observable circulation patterns. Two case studies tracing actual propagation:

Skibidi Toilet: Origin (Alexey Gerasimov, February 2023, Source Filmmaker machinima) → YouTube Shorts explosive growth → cross-platform jump (TikTok sound extraction, Instagram compilation) → offline uptake (school hallways, playground imitation) → institutional response (Indonesia school bans) → merchandise/IP capture. Audio-visual primary modality, character-based narrative, no payload.

6/7 Meme: Origin (Travis Scott "FE!N" release, late 2023) → TikTok sports edits → sound extraction and reuse → gestural uptake (hand signal) → trigger-response mechanics → school spread → district attempts at suppression. Audio-gestural primary modality, trigger-based, no payload.

Both demonstrate platform channel capabilities: massive synchronization, multi-modal propagation, offline crossover, institutional response as amplification. Both demonstrate flattening properties: no skill accumulation, no payload, repetition without transformation.

Implications for LSA design: channels are identified, modalities specified, timelines documented (4-10 months to mass saturation). Research gaps acknowledged.

Closes: "The roads have been mapped. The question now is what to send down them."

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THE ARC

The six documents trace a single argument:

SPE-012 establishes the axiom (the drive to mean is what we are, and it is being mined). SPE-013 shows the axiom reaches childhood (the enclosure is totalizing). SPE-014 names the class condition (semantic alienation, semantic class position). SPE-015 specifies the object of struggle (technique, not content). SPE-016 designs the intervention (liberatory algorithms at platform scale). SPE-016-APP-A maps the terrain (how semantic algorithms actually circulate).

From soul to strategy. From anthropology to engineering. From “the soul is not a dataset” to “the roads have been mapped — the question now is what to send down them.”

The Twenty-Dollar Loop (documented in this Studio’s deposit 227, DOI: 10.5281/zenodo.18474774) is the first answer to that question: a liberatory semantic algorithm designed according to the specifications laid out in this series and deployed through the channels mapped by this research.

This APZPZ registers the series. The documents live at their blog. The argument lives in the reading.

Keywords: semantic political economy, anthropological limit, drive to mean, semantic exhaustion, semantic exploitation, semantic alienation, class consciousness, semantic class, semantic technique, collective ownership, liberatory semantic algorithm, LSA, platform virality, brainrot, skibidi, 6/7, childhood language play, afterimage, modification vs circulation, semantic deskilling, assembly line, industrial channel, retreat error, capture resistance, semantic means of production, counter-infrastructure, Lee Sharks, Crimson Hexagon, Studio for Patacinematics, CC BY 4.0

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